



BONUS 01 • PRINTABLE

Communication Repair Script

Print it. Cut it down to a card if you want. Keep it somewhere you will actually see it – the fridge, a wallet, the inside cover of the book.

Use these when a conversation is heating up, or right before one you have been avoiding. Say the line exactly as written – the formality is the point.

The six lines

1. **"Can we start over?"** - the moment your voice sharpens.
2. **"I think I said that wrong - let me try again."** - right after you hear yourself land harder than you meant to.
3. **"I'm not trying to win this. I'm trying to understand you."** - when it starts feeling like a debate.
4. **"Can you say more about what that felt like for you?"** - when your instinct is to defend instead of listen.
5. **"I need five minutes before I can talk about this calmly."** - name an actual time, then come back at it.
6. **"You're more important to me than being right about this."** - when the topic is small but the tension is not.

Two lines to ask before a hard conversation, not during one

- "What's one thing that would help you feel safe telling me the truth right now?"
- "If I promise not to react right away, is there something you've been wanting to say?"

Make your own

These six work because they are specific, short, and said out loud on purpose - not because they are the only options. A repair attempt does not have to be a sentence at all:

- ☐ **Say something** - a phrase, like the six above.
- ☐ **Do something physical** - a hand on the arm, leaning in, softening your face.
- ☐ **Break the tension** - a shared joke that lightens the moment without dismissing the issue.
- ☐ **Do something small and practical** - bring water, sit down next to them instead of standing.

My own line or gesture
